

Richard Kwame Appiah

DATA CENTER & INFRASTRUCTURE OPERATIONS · SERVER · NETWORK · VENDOR DELIVERY

Takoradi & Accra, Ghana · Open to relocation to Tel Aviv, Israel Richard.k.appiah.ca@gmail.com +233 508 997 295

Shift / non-standard hours · Travel up to 50% English · Twi · Fanti

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure and data center operations professional with 9+ years across computing hardware, networking, operating systems, and critical-facility support in financial, telecom, and national-grid environments. Experienced coordinating vendors and contractors for equipment delivery and installation, leading technical incident response, and executing operational and security procedures that protect uptime and availability. Background includes data center NOC support (power, cooling, cabling, hardware), multi-country delivery work, staff enablement, and compliance programs aligned to ISO/IEC 27001 and critical-infrastructure standards. Seeking to apply this experience as a Data Center Operations Manager supporting Google Global Server Operations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Data Center Ops	Facility monitoring (power, cooling, cabling, hardware) · Server/hardware support · Uptime & availability · Preventative maintenance mindset · Compute & network lifecycle support
Delivery & Vendors	Vendor & contractor coordination · Installation follow-through · Escalation management · Cross-site / multi-country delivery · Trend tracking & operational improvement
Networking & Systems	Network defense · Active Directory · Endpoint protection · Linux/Windows environments · Backup/restore · Patching · SIEM/NOC monitoring
Safety & Compliance	Operational & security procedures · Physical security · ISO/IEC 27001 · Risk & non-conformance tracking · EHS-adjacent facility awareness (EPA/power collaboration)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems & Applications Specialist / Data Center NOC Support

Jan 2023 – Present

Bank of Ghana (FICSOC) — Virtual InfoSec Africa · Accra, Ghana

- Monitor data center infrastructure—including power, cooling, cabling, and hardware—to help maintain facility uptime, availability, and security for critical systems.
- Track network and application health with SIEM/NOC tooling; identify anomalies early and drive timely remediation.
- Lead end-to-end technical incident investigations, maintain operational documentation, and support reporting on trends and outcomes.
- Provide escalation support during high-severity incidents and coordinate response across technical and operational stakeholders.
- Coordinate vendors and contractors on equipment delivery and installation, keeping infrastructure work aligned to schedules and site requirements.
- Maintain and reinforce operational and security procedures; use monitoring and incident trends to identify improvement opportunities.

Penetration Tester / External IT Audit Representative

Jul 2019 – Nov 2022

Sophies Group · Ghana, Nigeria & Tanzania

- Delivered technical assessments and remediation guidance across multiple countries in a regional/global delivery model.
- Audited system configurations, access controls, and firewall policies; assessed physical security of critical infrastructure.
- Recommended perimeter/endpoint and breach-detection improvements that strengthened operational resilience.
- Trained 60+ staff on security awareness and cyber hygiene, reinforcing on-site security culture through coaching and enablement.
- Supported systems migration work by validating security and compliance controls; produced clear remediation reports for stakeholders.

Equipment Audit / Commercial Representative

Mar 2021 – Mar 2022

Helios Towers Ghana

- Validated operational data across 500+ tower sites to support reliable infrastructure lifecycle and field operations.
- Partnered with engineering on EPA allowances and power optimization, reinforcing environmental and operational discipline at scale.
- Supported audits, risk/compliance trackers, contract verification, and commercial data management for delivery accountability.

IT Support

Sep 2017 – Sep 2018

GRIDCo (Ghana Grid Company Limited)

- Delivered hands-on hardware/software support in a national critical-infrastructure environment; assisted backup/restore and Active Directory/Exchange support.
- Installed patches and anti-malware tooling; supported workstation rollouts and cabling infrastructure work.

IT Support (MIS)

Mar 2016 – May 2016

Volta River Authority

- Maintained MIS systems and resolved hardware, software, and network issues; supported inventory, backups, and equipment setup.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BSc, Information Technology — Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (Expected Jan 2027)

Associate Degree, Information Technology — Ghana Communication Technology University (Jan 2016)

Training: Critical Infrastructure Protection (U.S. DHS) · Physical Security / DoD CUI / RMF (DCSA) · ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Certified Auditor · Project Planning & Risk Management (UC Irvine) · Ethical Hacking (IPMC)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Oracle University — OCI Architect Associate
- Cisco Networking Academy — Network Defense
- The SecOps Group — Certified Network Security Practitioner
- LogRhythm (Exabeam) — Platform Administrator
- LogRhythm (Exabeam) — Security Analyst
- TÜV SÜD — ISO 27001:2022 Certified Lead Implementer
- EC-Council — Certified SOC Analyst (CSA)
- OneTrust — Incident Management Expert
- TCM Security — Practical Windows Forensics
- TCM Security — Practical Ethical Hacking
- Lean Six Sigma White Belt — PMI / Process Management International